



## TradeLog — NIFTY 50 Swing Trade Journal

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| 📅 Date     | March 2, 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| ≡ Domain   | FinTech/Personal Analytics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| ≡ Lead For | <span>Consumer analytics</span> <span>Fianace</span> <span>FinTech</span> <span>Investment</span>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| ≡ Summary  | TradeLog is a mobile-first journaling app for NIFTY 50 swing traders that fixes inconsistent & dishonest logging. It enables sub-3-minute entries with India-specific tags (RSI Divergence, Bollinger Squeeze, Expiry Week) and emotional prompts like "What were you thinking?". Helps part-time traders break emotional loops, validate setups with real data, and improve consistency from ~40% to 80%+. |
| ⚙ status   | <span>In progress</span>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |

## TradeLog — NIFTY 50 Swing Trade Journal

### A Product Case Study

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**Product Type:** Personal Fintech Tool — Solo-Founded

**Status:** Concept → Prototype

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## 1. Background

I have been trading NIFTY 50 on a swing basis for a while now. Not full-time, but seriously enough that losses actually sting and wins feel earned. I use RSI divergence, Fibonacci retracements, ADX, and Bollinger Bands – the standard toolkit for anyone who has spent enough time on TradingView to develop strong opinions about timeframes.

The problem was never the setups. Most of the time I could read the chart reasonably well. The problem was that I kept making the same mistakes in the same emotional states and had absolutely no way to prove that to myself because I wasn't writing anything down in a systematic way.

There was one trade in early 2026 that pushed me to finally build something. I entered a NIFTY position on an RSI divergence signal on the 15-minute chart. The trade moved 40 points in my favour. I exited. Felt good. Then watched it run another 120 points without me over the next two sessions. I had no record of why I exited when I did — not the market condition, not what I was feeling, not what my original target was. So I couldn't learn anything from it. I just sat with the regret and moved on, which is the worst possible outcome from a trade you actually got right.

 That's when I started thinking about TradeLog.

## 2. Problem Statement

Most retail traders in India know they should keep a journal. Almost none of them actually do it consistently, and the ones who try usually give up within two weeks.

The existing options aren't built for how Indian swing traders actually work. Generic spreadsheets require too much manual input. Notion templates feel like homework. Apps like Edgewonk are designed for a global audience and don't account for things like F&O expiry weeks, NIFTY-specific setup tags, or the fact that a lot of retail traders here are trading on their phone between other responsibilities.

But the deeper problem is emotional. After a losing trade, logging it means confronting what went wrong. After a winning trade where you left money on the table, logging it means admitting you exited out of fear. Most journaling tools treat trading as a purely mechanical activity — fill in entry price, exit price, and P&L. They completely miss the psychological layer, which is where most of the actual learning happens.

The result is that traders stay stuck. They know their setups theoretically. They cannot tell you whether their RSI divergence entries perform better in trending or ranging markets because they've never tracked it. They keep repeating emotional mistakes because they've never forced themselves to name those mistakes at the time they're making them.

TradeLog is built to fix that specific failure — not by adding more features, but by reducing the friction of honest logging to the point where skipping it feels worse than doing it.



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### 3. User Research

I didn't run formal surveys for this. What I did was pay attention — to my own trading, to conversations in trading communities on Telegram and Discord, and to a few direct conversations with other NIFTY traders in my network. Here's what I actually found.

**The exit regret loop is universal.** Every trader I spoke to described the same psychological pattern. You exit a trade early because something feels uncertain. The trade continues in your direction. You feel stupid. Next time, you hold too long to compensate for it. You give back profits. There's no record of either decision, so the loop just continues. One trader I spoke to — a software engineer who trades part-time, three to four days a week — said she'd been trading Bollinger Band squeeze entries for almost a year and genuinely didn't know if they worked in trending markets versus ranging ones. She had a gut feeling but no data. That stuck with me because she's not a careless trader. She reads, she studies, she practises. She just never tracked anything systematically.

**Logging friction kills the habit.** I tried keeping a journal in Excel for about six weeks in late 2025. The problem wasn't the format — it was the time. After closing a trade I'd spend fifteen to twenty minutes reconstructing everything from memory. By the time I was halfway through, I was already second-guessing my recollection of what I was thinking at entry. The further you get from the trade, the less honest the record becomes. Whatever I built had to capture the key data in under three minutes or it wouldn't survive contact with reality.

**F&O expiry weeks behave differently.** This came up in almost every conversation. Expiry weeks on NIFTY — especially the weekly ones — have different volatility profiles, different stop-hunt patterns, and different risks. Generic journaling tools have no concept of this. A trade logged on expiry Thursday and a trade logged on a regular Tuesday are treated identically, which makes pattern analysis across setups nearly useless for someone trading Indian derivatives.

**People don't log losses honestly.** This one is obvious in retrospect, but I didn't fully appreciate it until I reviewed my own rough notes from 2025. I had detailed notes on winning trades. My losing trades had entries

like "stopped out, bad day. " No setup tag, no emotion note, no context. The losses — which are exactly where the learning lives — were the least documented. Any good journaling tool has to actively design against this tendency.

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## 4. Target Personas

### Persona 1 — Harsh, Active Swing Trader

That's me. I trade NIFTY 50 using a defined setup framework. I analyse charts after every trade but keep notes inconsistently. My specific frustration is exit timing — I either exit too early out of fear or hold too long trying to compensate for a previous early exit. I have no systematic record of what I was thinking at the time of either decision, which means I can't improve in any structured way.

What I need is something that captures my trade data and my emotional state in the same place, with almost zero friction, so that over time I can start seeing patterns in both.

| Attribute          | Detail                                                                               |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Age / Role         | MBA student, active NIFTY swing trader                                               |
| Setup toolkit      | RSI Divergence, Fibonacci, ADX, Bollinger Bands                                      |
| Trading frequency  | Multiple times per week, swing positions                                             |
| Current journaling | Inconsistent rough notes, no systematic record                                       |
| Core frustration   | Exit timing — exits too early out of fear, or holds too long to compensate           |
| What's needed      | Structured log of trade data + emotional state in one place, under 3 minutes to fill |

### Persona 2 — Priya, Part-Time Trader

Thirty-four years old. Software engineer. Trades two to three times a week, mostly evenings and weekends. Has read the books — Mark Douglas, Van Tharp, and the classics. Understands setup theory reasonably well.

Her problem is that she's been trading the same setups for over a year without any performance data to validate whether they're actually working for her, in the specific market conditions she trades in.

She's not looking for signals or advice. She wants a clean way to track what she's doing so she can figure out for herself what's working. She tried Notion once. Abandoned it after three weeks because setup was too complex and the blank-page format didn't guide her toward the right questions.

| Attribute          | Detail                                                                               |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Age / Role         | 34, software engineer, trades 2–3 times per week                                     |
| Setup toolkit      | Bollinger Band squeeze entries, technical analysis self-taught                       |
| Trading frequency  | Evenings and weekends around work schedule                                           |
| Current journaling | Tried Notion, abandoned after three weeks                                            |
| Core frustration   | Has traded the same setups for a year, no data on whether they actually work for her |
| What's needed      | Guided logging structure that asks the right questions without a blank page          |

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## 5. User Journey

## Current State — How It Actually Goes

Priya enters a Bollinger Band squeeze trade on NIFTY at 10:45am. The trade moves against her initially; she holds, it recovers and hits her target. She exits. Feels good.

That evening she opens Notion to log it. The blank page stares at her. She types the entry price, exit price, and rough P&L. Closes the laptop. Doesn't log the market condition, doesn't note that she almost exited at the first red candle, doesn't tag the setup. Two weeks later she's trying to figure out if her Bollinger entries are working. She has twelve rows in a table, half of them incomplete, none of them tagged. She can't answer the question.

## With TradeLog

Priya closes the trade. She opens TradeLog on her phone. The entry form has five structured fields — instrument, direction, entry, exit, stop loss — and auto-calculates P&L and R:R the moment she fills them in. She taps "Bollinger Squeeze" from the pre-built tag row. She selects "Ranging" from the market condition dropdown. She types four words in the emotion box: "held through the dip". She attaches a screenshot. Total time: two minutes and twenty seconds.

On Sunday evening she opens the Review screen. She can see that her Bollinger Squeeze entries in ranging markets have a 68% win rate over the last six weeks. In trending markets, 31%. She didn't need to calculate that. She just needed to have logged it.

 *The future state isn't dramatically different in steps. It's different in texture. Priya never faces a blank page. The structure asks the questions she would have skipped.*

## 6. Pain Points

| Pain Point                                                     | Who Feels It          | Root Cause                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| 15–20 min to reconstruct a trade from memory                   | Every trader          | No structured in-the-moment logging flow             |
| No Indian market context (F&O expiry, lot sizes, NIFTY setups) | Indian retail traders | All tools built for global/US market                 |
| Emotional state never captured                                 | Every trader          | Tools treat trading as mechanical, ignore psychology |
| Losing trades under-documented                                 | Every trader          | No structural design to overcome emotional avoidance |
| Can't see setup-level win rate after months of trading         | Every trader          | Data was never consistently collected                |

## 7. Competitive Analysis

There are tools in this space but none of them quite fit the problem as I've defined it.

- **Edgewonk:** Probably the most serious journaling tool available. It's comprehensive, has psychology tracking, and generates real performance reports. But it's built for a global audience, it's desktop-first, it costs money, and it has no concept of the Indian derivatives market. For a retail NIFTY trader in India, it's like using enterprise software to solve a personal problem.

- **TraderSync:** Cleaner UI and better mobile support than Edgewonk. I looked at it seriously before deciding to build. The broker import feature is genuinely useful, but the emotional tracking layer is thin — a single notes field, nothing guided — and there's no F&O expiry awareness anywhere in the product.
- **Excel / Google Sheets:** What most serious traders actually use. Completely customisable, no cost. But it requires building your own structure, there's no guided logging flow, and the emotional context almost never gets captured because a blank cell doesn't prompt you the way a structured field does. My own six weeks of Excel journaling proved this.
- **Notion templates:** Popular in Indian trading communities. They look good. They almost always get abandoned within a month because Notion is a blank canvas and blank canvases don't create habits. Priya's story in the personas section is the Notion experience almost exactly.

🧠 *What's missing across all of them: a fast, mobile-friendly, India-specific journaling tool that captures both structured trade data and emotional context in a single 2–3 minute flow with built-in setup tags for Indian retail strategies and expiry-week awareness. That's the gap TradeLog sits in.*

## 8. Success Metrics

These are the numbers I'd actually check to know if this thing is working.

| Metric                        | Baseline                   | Target                           | Why It Matters                                      |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Time to log a trade           | 15–20 minutes              | Under 3 minutes                  | If logging takes longer than this, the habit dies   |
| 30-day logging consistency    | ~40% of trades (estimated) | 80%+ of trades logged            | Consistency is the product's core value proposition |
| Loss trade logging rate       | ~30–40% of losses          | Equal to win rate logging        | Proves the emotional barrier is being overcome      |
| Win rate visibility per setup | Not tracked                | Exact % per tag available        | The core analytical output                          |
| Weekly review completion      | Zero                       | 70%+ of weeks                    | Where the learning actually happens                 |
| Average session time          | N/A                        | Under 5 minutes for log + review | Keeps the habit sustainable                         |

## 9. Wireframe Descriptions

### Trade Entry Screen

The entry form is minimal by design. Five core fields at the top: instrument (defaulting to NIFTY), direction, entry price, exit price, and stop loss. As soon as entry and exit are filled, P&L and R:R calculate automatically and display in real time below the form — no submit button is needed for that. Below that, a horizontal scrollable row of setup tags: RSI Divergence, Fibonacci, Bollinger Squeeze, ADX Trend, Breakout, and another option that lets you type a custom tag. One dropdown for market condition: trending up, trending down, ranging, volatile. One small checkbox: Expiry Week. At the bottom, a single open text box is labelled "What

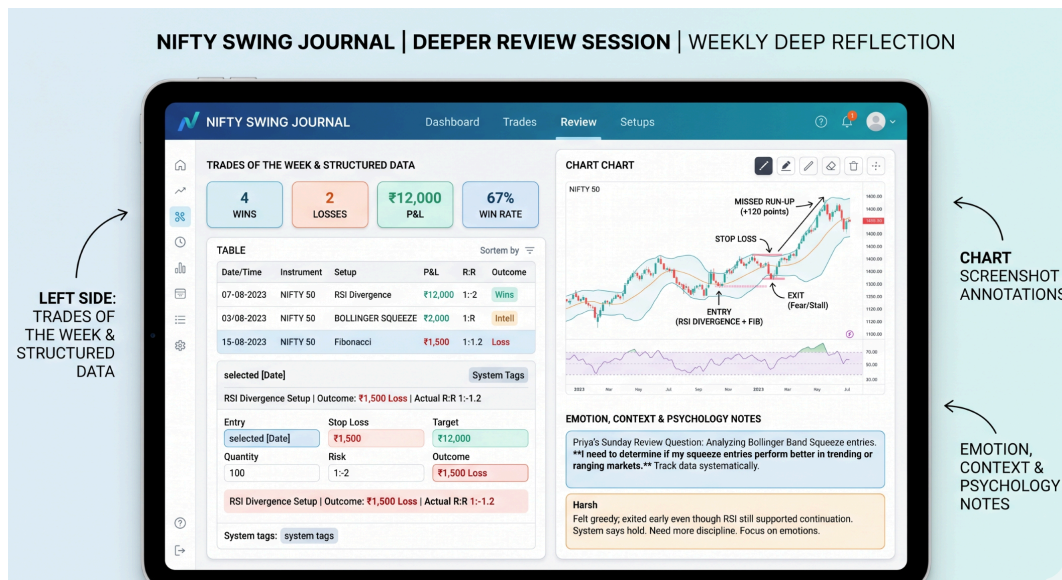
were you thinking?" — not "Notes" or "Comments", but specifically that question. One-tap screenshot attachment. A prominent Log Trade button.

## Dashboard Screen

Four summary cards at the top: Total Trades, Win Rate, Total P&L, Average R:R. Below that, a performance breakdown by setup tag showing win rate and average R:R for each tag used. Below that, a filterable list of recent trades — filter by setup tag, market condition, expiry week, and outcome. The filters are chips, not dropdowns, so they're one tap each.

## Weekly Review Screen

Four summary cards at the top: Total Trades, Win Rate, Total P&L, Average R:R. Below that, a performance breakdown by setup tag showing win rate and average R:R for each tag used. Below that, a filterable list of recent trades — filter by setup tag, market condition, expiry week, and outcome. The filters are chips, not dropdowns, so they're one tap each.



## 10. Feature Specification

### P0 — Must Have at Launch

- Fast trade entry form with auto-calculated P&L, Risk-Reward, and outcome
- Pre-built Indian setup tags (RSI Divergence, Fibonacci, Bollinger Squeeze, ADX Trend, Breakout)
- Market condition tagging and F&O expiry week checkbox
- "What were you thinking?" (emotion and context field)
- Basic performance dashboard with win rate and P&L per setup tag
- Local storage so the app works without internet

### P1 — Next Build Cycle

- Advanced filtering by any combination of tag, market condition, expiry week, outcome, date range



- Chart screenshot attachment with basic annotation support
- Weekly review screen with forced reflection prompt
- Push notification on Sunday evenings as a review reminder

## P2 — Future

- Anonymised community benchmarking — see how your RSI Divergence win rate compares to other TradeLog users without any personal data shared
- Optional read-only broker API integration with Zerodha or Groww to auto-fill entry and exit prices



### Non-Goals:

TradeLog will not execute trades, generate signals, screen stocks, or give investment advice of any kind. It is strictly a post-trade journaling and analysis tool.

## 11. Feature Prioritisation — RICE

RICE scoring: Reach (queries/month), Impact (0.5 = minor / 1.0 = solid / 2.0 = core problem), Confidence, and Effort (person-months).

$$Score = (Reach \times Impact \times Confidence) / Effort.$$

| Feature                         | Reach | Impact | Confidence | Effort | RICE | Priority |
|---------------------------------|-------|--------|------------|--------|------|----------|
| Fast trade entry + auto P&L     | 500   | 2.0    | 90%        | 1.0    | 900  | P0       |
| Indian setup tags + expiry flag | 500   | 2.0    | 85%        | 0.5    | 1700 | P0       |
| Emotion / context field         | 500   | 2.0    | 80%        | 0.5    | 1600 | P0       |
| Performance dashboard           | 400   | 2.0    | 85%        | 1.5    | 453  | P0       |
| Offline local storage           | 500   | 2.0    | 90%        | 1.0    | 900  | P0       |
| Advanced filtering              | 400   | 1.0    | 80%        | 1.0    | 320  | P1       |
| Screenshot + annotation         | 300   | 1.0    | 75%        | 1.5    | 150  | P1       |
| Weekly review screen            | 400   | 2.0    | 75%        | 1.5    | 400  | P1       |
| Broker API integration          | 300   | 1.0    | 50%        | 3.0    | 50   | P2       |
| Community benchmarking          | 200   | 0.5    | 60%        | 2.0    | 30   | P2       |

Indian setup tags and the emotion field score highest not because they are technically complex — they're actually lightweight to build — but because the effort is low and the reach is every single user on every single



trade. The setup tag solves the data collection problem at the point of logging; without it, no performance analysis is possible downstream. The emotion field scores almost as high because it's the feature that makes TradeLog different from every other journaling tool in the market. Pulling it to a later build cycle would mean shipping something that looks like every other solution I already decided not to use.

## 12. Risks and Trade-offs

| Risk                   | Description                                                                                                                                 | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Manual entry fatigue   | If logging creeps past 3 minutes the habit breaks. Every feature decision must be measured against whether it adds or reduces logging time. | Strict 3-minute constraint on entry flow. Any feature that adds a required field gets challenged.                                                               |
| Emotional honesty      | Can't force a trader to fill the context field honestly. Surface-level entries defeat the purpose.                                          | Friction design — make the honest answer easier than leaving it blank. Weekly review shows what you wrote against what happened.                                |
| Regulatory positioning | Tool discussing win rates and strategies sits uncomfortably close to investment advice territory in India.                                  | Strict scope: no signals, no recommendations. Every screen carries a disclaimer. Positioned as personal diary, not advisory tool.                               |
| Selective logging      | Traders log wins reliably, losses rarely. Distorts performance data.                                                                        | Weekly review lists unlogged sessions and blocks access to weekly stats until incomplete trades are filled. The one place the product is deliberately annoying. |

## 13. Rollout Plan

### Phase 1: Personal Validation (Weekly 1-6)

Build the MVP and use it myself for every NIFTY trade I take over six weeks. The goal is not to prove it works—it's to find every moment where I'm tempted to skip a log entry or work around the structure. Those moments are the product bugs.

### Phase 2 — Closed Testing (Weeks 7–10)

Share the prototype with eight to ten traders from Telegram and Discord communities I'm already a part of. Not a formal beta, just a shared link and a fifteen-minute walkthrough call. Weekly check-ins to hear what's breaking down in real usage.

### Phase 3 — Iteration and Wider Release

Based on phase 2 feedback, one round of meaningful fixes is needed. Then a wider release through the same trading communities, with a simple landing page explaining what the product is and what it specifically doesn't do.

## 14. Retrospective

The biggest thing I learned building this product, even at the concept stage, is that the real competition isn't other journaling tools. It's the part of every trader's brain that doesn't want to confront an honest record of

their own behaviour.

A tool that's technically perfect but psychologically uncomfortable will lose to a Notes app that lets you write vague things and feel fine about it. So every design decision in TradeLog had to answer the question: does this make honest logging easier or harder? The forced reflection prompt on the weekly review screen — where you can't close the screen without writing one thing you're changing — is the decision I feel most strongly about and the one I'd fight hardest to keep if someone told me to remove it.

The emotion field was the other big one. Every version of this I sketched early on had "Notes" as the label. I changed it to "What were you thinking?" because that's actually the question. The word 'change' sounds small. In practice, it changes what people write. "Notes" invites you to describe the chart. "What were you thinking?" invites you to describe yourself. That's the whole point of the product.

If I were building this again from scratch, I'd have started the research phase by just asking traders to show me their existing journals — whatever form those take. The gap between what people think they track and what they actually track is enormous, and seeing it directly would have shaped the feature priorities faster than anything else.

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## 15. Expected Impact

If TradeLog works the way it's designed to, the impact shows up in a few specific places.

The most immediate one is logging consistency. Right now most traders I know log maybe 40% of their trades, heavily skewed toward wins. If TradeLog gets that to 80% with equal representation of wins and losses, the analytical output becomes meaningful for the first time.

The second is setup-level performance clarity. After six weeks of consistent logging, a trader should be able to answer, "Does my RSI divergence entry actually work for me?" with real data. That question — which most traders cannot answer after years of trading — is the core value proposition.

The third, and hardest to measure, is emotional pattern awareness. If the "What were you thinking?" field gets filled honestly over dozens of trades, traders will start to see their own psychological patterns in a way that no amount of chart study produces. Fear-based exits cluster around certain market conditions. Overconfidence shows up after winning streaks. You can't see those patterns until you've named them at the time they're happening.

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 *After six weeks of using this myself, I expect to finally answer whether RSI divergence entries actually work for me in ranging markets versus trending ones. That question has been sitting open for several years. The data exists — it just never got written down.*